Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy	$742.96 ▲ 3.38%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$820.00	$520.26 – $779.82	$1.89T

META: Bounce Looks Real, But Options Flow Says Caution

WHAT HAPPENED

- META ripped +3.4% on 24.7M shares (nearly 2x normal volume) after bleeding 4 straight sessions down to $718. No overnight news, no filings — this looks like a technical bounce off the $720 support zone PLUS sympathy with the broader risk-on tape (Energy +1.4%, Staples +1.2% — a weird "everything rally" that usually means systematic buyers / short covering).
- BUT — and this matters — the options tape is screaming the opposite direction. Someone paid $17M for near-the-money Oct $740 puts and loaded up at $747.50 strikes at 309x open interest. That's not retail. That's an institution buying downside protection RIGHT at today's price. Translation: smart money thinks this bounce fades.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading between the lines: the rally is real but fragile. You've got the COO (Olivan) cluster-selling into strength last week, you've got massive unusual put buying today, and you've got Comm Services as a sector basically flat over 5 days (-0.14%) — meaning META is bouncing on its own, not because the group is leading. That's a setup where a disappointing Q3 print (earnings land late October) could gap this thing back to $700 fast. On the flip side, if earnings beat and management guides AI capex productively, the shorts and put holders get torched and we're above $780 in a week. The political backdrop is actually a tailwind here — the current administration has been notably hands-off on Big Tech AI buildouts (unlike the EU), and the TikTok divestiture saga keeps Reels in prime position to grab share.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

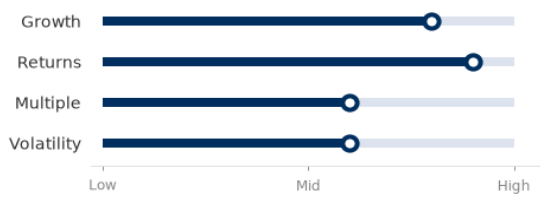
Three things on my radar: (1) The FTC antitrust case targeting Instagram/WhatsApp spin-off is still grinding through appeals — a loss here is the single biggest existential risk, but timing is likely 2027+. (2) The TikTok forced-sale deadline keeps getting kicked, and every extension is a mini-win for Meta — Reels monetization has been the quiet margin story. (3) Watch the AI infrastructure permitting reform bill moving through the Senate — if it passes, it accelerates data center buildouts (power, land) which directly helps Meta's $70B+ AI capex plan land faster and cheaper. Net-net: regulatory environment is friendlier than it's been in 5 years, EXCEPT for the one big antitrust tail risk.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

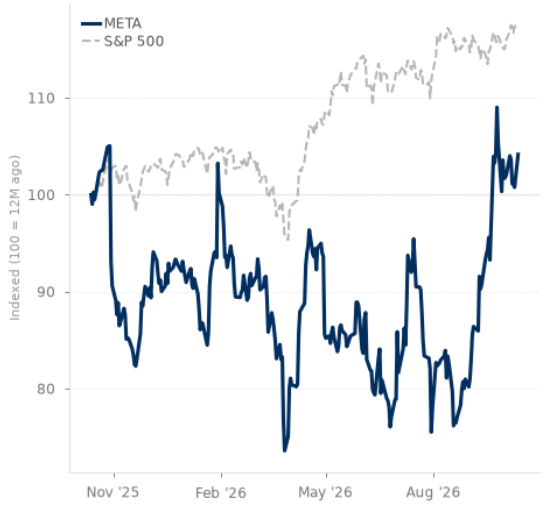
Key Data

Price (USD)	**$742.96**
12M Price Target	**$820.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+10.4%**
Market Cap	**$1.89T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$198M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$228M**
FY2026E EPS	**$27.50**
FY2027E EPS	**$32.00**
Fwd P/E	**27.0x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

META — Meta Platforms, Inc. | October 12, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$790.00**	$755.00	**$695.00**
6 Months	**$850.00**	$790.00	**$680.00**
1 Year	**$900.00**	$820.00	**$650.00**
2 Years	**$1050.00**	$900.00	**$620.00**
5 Years	**$1400.00**	$1100.00	**$600.00**
10 Years	**$2200.00**	$1600.00	**$550.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4% in 5 days) and Staples (+4.2%) — classic defensive/inflation-hedge rotation. That's not a "risk on" tape, that's investors hedging. Healthcare also quietly firming.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (-0.14% over 5 days) despite today's bounce — META, GOOGL, NFLX haven't been leading. That tells you today's META move is idiosyncratic, not sector-driven.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing toward hard assets and defensives, which usually precedes either a growth scare or a rate-cut repricing. If it's a growth scare, META's ad business is cyclical and gets hit. If it's rate cuts, META's long-duration AI investments get re-rated higher.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI capex story, the "picks and shovels" trade is still working — think VRT (Vertiv), ETN (Eaton), and the data center REITs (EQIX, DLR). Meta's $70B spend has to land somewhere.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NFLX (Netflix): Ad-tier scaling faster than expected, and no Reality Labs cash drain — the market's rewarding "focused" ad plays right now.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Search holding up vs. ChatGPT fears, cloud growth re-accelerating — the "AI winner that's not Nvidia" trade.

META CONTEXT: META is middle-of-the-pack in its peer group — not leading like NFLX, not re-rated like GOOGL. That's actually constructive — it means expectations are reasonable going into earnings. Leaders get punished for in-line prints; laggards get rewarded for beats. META fits the latter.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: $715-725 on pullbacks, or breakout above $780

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Ad revenue growth drops below 10% YoY, or adverse FTC antitrust ruling forcing Instagram/WhatsApp divestiture

Hedging: Buy Nov $700 puts, or pair-trade long META / short GOOGL on antitrust risk

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